for sovereignty, mutual non-aggression, non-interference, equality, and peaceful coexistence.

Later, over some time, China emerged as a robust global economy. With the rise of the Chinese economy, China's emergence as a significant economic, political, and military power is now a reality due to its economic, military, and political clout (Zhu 2008). However, recent trends in US foreign policy compelled China and Russia to re-check their military expenditure and foreign policy objectives and aspirations. The US encirclement of the Eurasian region, coupled with the NATO expansion toward legitimate Russian territory, and the 'Asia pivot,' or the re-balance of Asian strategy to counter China has created concern. Nazemroaya (2012) said Pentagon seems to be encircling the 'Eurasian Triple Entente' consisting of China, Russia, and Iran … and argued that neither one among these countries would sit idly. According to the changes in US foreign policy, Russia–China is also building its economic, political, and military strength over time.

Indeed, the United States has become a common threat to the Russian and Chinese foreign policymakers. Russia and China are enhancing their military expenditure to become secure if war occurs. According to Akulov (2013b), who claimed that the spending of China and Russia on military equipment increased gigantically, 'Emerging military superpowers China and Russia sharply increased military expenditures in 2012, while spending by the United States and most NATO-aligned European countries contracted' (Akulov 2013b). Furthermore, according to a 2013 report by Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI), which is an independent think tank, military investment of Russia and China along with other developing nations was increasing, whereas, in the developed world like in the United States and other NATO members, it was decelerating. Further, the think tank said, the US share of the world's military spending in 2012 lessened below 40 percent. This has happened for the first time in US history since the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991. China and Russia raised their expenditure sharply, with China from 7.8 percent or $7.8 billion to $166 billion in 2012. Likewise, Russia mushroomed its spending by 16 percent, from $12.3 billion to $90.7 billion (ibid.). Again, according to the same think tank 2016 report, Russia's share on military spending from its GDP is 5.3, whereas the US share from its GDP on military spending is 3.3 percent only (Nantian et al. 2017). Further, the SIPRI 2020 report says that